

really feel at home. This campaign just comes alive with a bunch of Eskimos in backdrop of the icy cold North Pole. But for a seasonal ad campaign, is it really necessary to go up there? That apart, equipment and crew, transport, formalities and other ancillary costs would drive the budget way beyond scope. If you can get the same effect in a fraction of the cost, what better than that? Use Adobe Photoshop and you have a ready and effective solution to all your needs.

3.1 The Concept Of Layers

While writing this article, it is easy to edit a few words here and there without disturbing the rest of the document. But, doing the same with images? We doubt in spite of their talent, even Michelangelo or Raphael would have preferred to rework! This is where layers come into play. Let us take the same example of the ad for ACs. Let's assume we have the close-ups of the AC we want to sell. We also have a beautiful backdrop of the ice-laden scenic view of the North Pole. Rather than drawing a picture of the AC on the frame of the cold environment, the best and time tested option is to superimpose the two, such that you can move the AC around anytime you want, depending on which location best suits your concept. This is possible using layers. Let us take another example to understand this better. We all have worked on MS Paint. You know how painful it is, if after creating your masterpiece in it, you were told that you needed the AC on the left instead of the right. If you're working on a white background, you might just save your skin, but you may not be lucky that often. This is where you get to know the true power of layers—all you'd have to do is move the layer on which you pasted the AC. It's like a bunch of transparency sheets stacked together—depending on their positioning, you see the final picture.

Layers are used to reduce the effect of mistakes, and preventing the original image from being damaged. You can protect the original image by creating the first layer. Create a copy of the back-